APRIL 2025 NEWSLETTER

# VENTURES VOYAGE

Newsletter By
BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM

# SUCCESS

*From Ideas To Income*

# INTRODUCTION

In today's competitive business world, just getting new customers is not enough. Companies also need to make sure that their old or existing customers stay loyal and keep coming back. This is called customer retention – in simple words, it's all about keeping your customers happy so they don't leave you for someone else.

When customers are satisfied, they are more likely to buy again, tell others about your business, and even forgive small mistakes. That's why smart companies focus not only on selling their products or services but also on building good relationships with their customers.

To retain customers, companies use many simple yet powerful strategies. They provide excellent customer service, listen to customer feedback, solve complaints quickly, and give loyalty rewards. Some businesses even send thank-you notes or personalized messages to make their customers feel special.

Other than this, staying in touch through emails or social media helps customers remember your brand. Giving discounts to repeat customers or offering special deals can also make them feel valued

In short, keeping your customers happy, heard, and appreciated is the secret to customer retention. A loyal customer is not just a buyer – they become your brand supporter for the long run.

In this write-up, we will explore some simple and effective strategies that companies use to keep their customers satisfied, loyal, and connected for the long run.

Priyanka Nagar
MBA- IB

# TATA NEU: A SUPER APP'S STRATEGY TO KEEP USERS ENGAGED

Tata Neu, the ambitious super app launched by the Tata Group in April 2022, is redefining customerretention in India's dynamic digital landscape. By integrating diverse services such as shopping,travel, health, and finance under one umbrella, with renowned brands like BigBasket, Croma, Air India, 1mg, and Tata CLiQ. Tata Neu simplifies the user experience while building lasting customer relationships. Central to its retention strategy is the NeuCoins loyalty program, an unified rewards system that incentivizes repeat usage across categories by awarding coins on every transaction,which can later be redeemed on various services.

TATA NEU
Shop • Travel • Pay

***IT's True, It's NEU***

Advanced data analytics further enable hyper-personalization, offering discounts and tailored recommendations that enhance user satisfaction and foster recurring engagement. Leveraging Tata's legacy, the app creates an integrated ecosystem where services seamlessly interconnect. For instance, customers can earn and spend NeuCoins across different domains, from booking flights to shopping online. Complementing these efforts, Tata Neu offers digital wallets, UPI payments, and exclusive subscriptions like Neu Pass, along with robust customer support backed by a trusted brand reputation. Although facing fierce competition, Tata Neu continues to refine its interface, speed, and reward structures, aiming to set the benchmark for super apps in India.

**Nishant Inamdar**
**MBA – IB**

# TAILOR THE USER EXPERIENCE: ZOMATO'S RECIPE FOR RETENTION

Ever feel like your food app knows you a little too well? You open it, and there's your favorite biryani place, a 20% off on that pizza you love, or a reminder it's lunchtime with a new thali combo trending nearby. Coincidence? Not quite. Its personalization is done right—and Zomato has mastered the art.

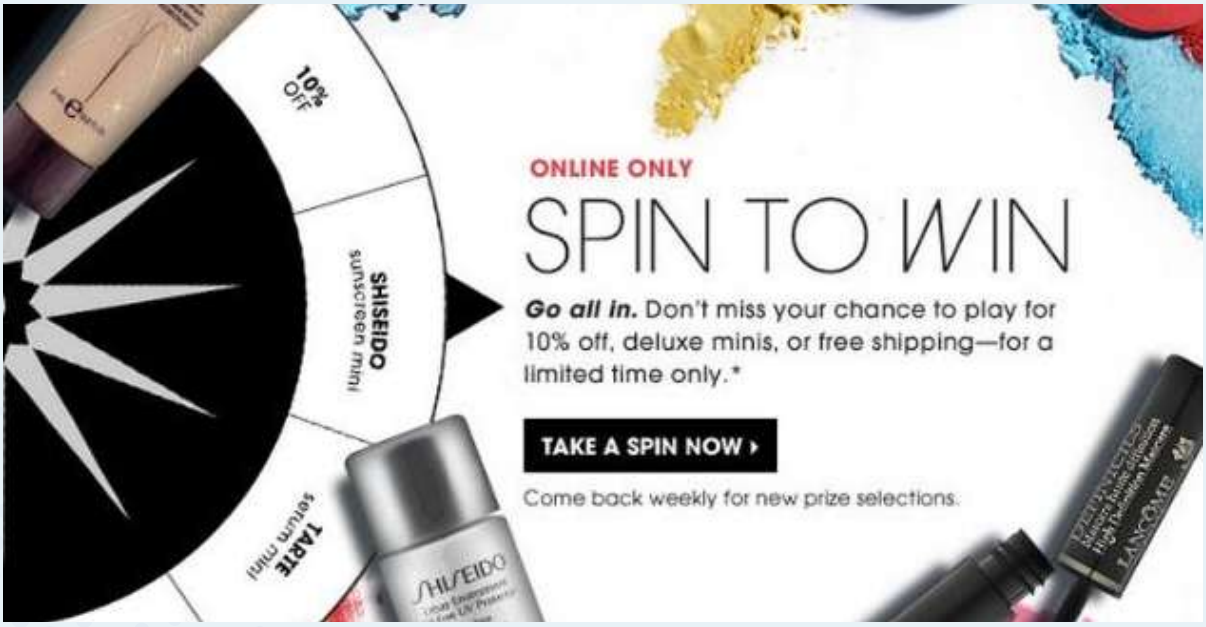
In today's digital world, personalization isn't a luxury; it's an expectation. Zomato leverages user data—like location, cuisine preferences, and past orders—to recommend just the right options. The app's dynamic homepage shows trending eateries, time-based meal deals, and relevant offers that keep users coming back. Add Zomato Pro to the mix—exclusive discounts and faster deliveries—and you've got a recipe for loyalty. The result? A 30% jump in customer retention and 23% more repeat orders in just a year.

Entrepreneur's Takeaway: Whether you're running a food venture or a fashion startup, personalization can elevate your customer experience. You don't need fancy AI—start small with CRM data, surveys, and feedback loops. Understand your audience, tailor their journey, and they'll reward you with trust, loyalty, and word-of-mouth magic. In business, relevance isn't just smart—it's essential.

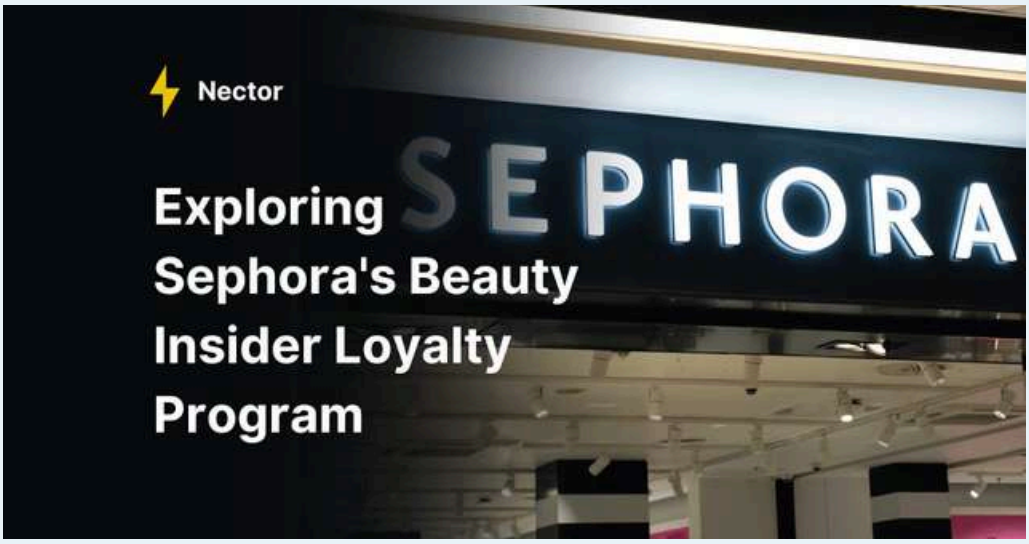
**Sushmita Poojari**
**MBA - Finance**

# "GLOW AND GROW : SEPHORA'S FORMULA OR CUSTOMER RETENTION"

Sephora has established a standard for customer loyalty and involvement through a combination of bespoke experiences, cutting-edge technology, and community. At the centre of its plan is the Beauty Insider Loyalty Program, providing tiered rewards, special gifts, and access to new products first, keeping customers involved and appreciated. Sephora also employs personalization, utilizing customer information to provide customized product recommendations and beauty advice, giving users a heightened experience online and in-store.




The omnichannel strategy of the brand ensures a smooth buying experience, encompassing virtual try-ons, online consultations, and in-store pickup. Physical as well as virtual expert consultations promote trust by ensuring personalized guidance. Sephora invests in training as well by offering tutorials and complimentary beauty lessons, which equip customers and make them more deeply connected to the brand.




A robust community engagement through social media and forums drives loyalty and emotional bonding, while convenient returns and quick delivery increase convenience. By merging technology with human interaction, Sephora builds a community where customers feel heard, rewarded, and inspired — converting one-time shoppers into permanent brand enthusiasts.

## Key Customer Retention Strategies at Sephora:

- Beauty Insider Loyalty Program (tiered rewards)
- Personalized product recommendations
- Omnichannel shopping (online + in-store)
- Free beauty classes and tutorials
- Expert beauty consultations
- Strong online community and social media engagement
- Easy returns and fast shipping

SEPHORA

Ishika Jangra
MBA - HR

# REVIVING CUSTOMER CONNECTIONS: NYKAA'S EFFECTIVE SMS AND EMAIL WIN-BACK CAMPAIGNS

Nykaa, a leading beauty and wellness retailer, has effectively utilised SMS and email marketing to re-engage customers who have become inactive. These "win-back" campaigns aim to rekindle interest among users who haven't interacted with the brand in a while, boosting retention and encouraging repeat purchases.

SMS marketing is particularly powerful because of its immediacy and high open rates. Nykaa capitalises on this by sending personalised messages, often with exclusive deals or time-sensitive offers. By using urgency and customisation, such as "Hurry, Your Offer Expires Soon," the brand sparks curiosity and motivates lapsed customers to take action quickly.

Similarly, email campaigns allow Nykaa to send more detailed and visually appealing content to its customers. By analysing past customer behavior—such as previous purchases or abandoned carts—Nykaa can send tailored emails with relevant product suggestions or discounts. These emails also often feature compelling subject lines and attention-grabbing visuals, encouraging recipients to visit the website and complete their purchases.

Both SMS and email strategies help Nykaa revive interest from past customers, not only increasing immediate sales but also strengthening long-term customer loyalty through personalized and engaging experiences.

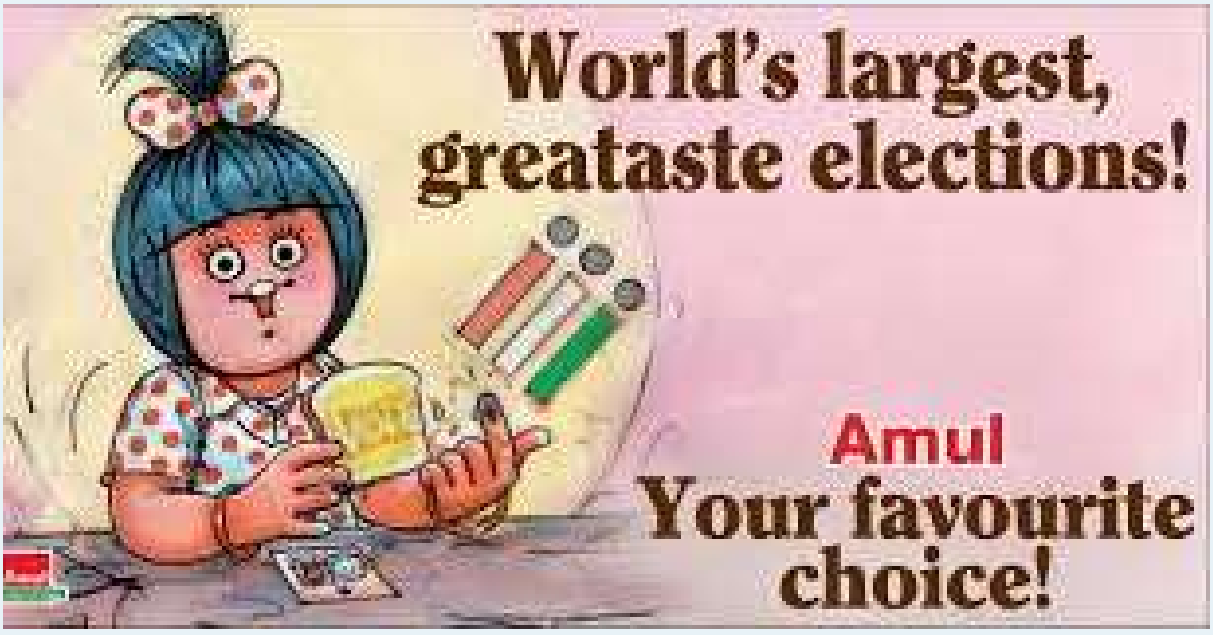
**Tanaya Zad**
**MBA - Finance**

# STAY IN TOUCH AND GO THE EXTRA MILE: AMUL'S CUSTOMER RETENTION STRATEGY

To stay alive in today's competitive age, retaining current customers is as crucial as gaining new customers. Amul, India's most trusted dairy brand, is an example of how staying connected and going that extra mile can keep a business on the move in the long run.

Amul reaches out to its customers in many innovative manners. Its topical ads, which humorously target modern issues in a matter-of-fact and humorous manner, interest the public and emotionally attach them to the brand. Amul also leverages social media sites to regularly update, posting recipes, news, and trivia to place the brand top of mind.

Quality consistency is also another key strategy. Milk, butter, cheese, or ice cream, anyone is aware of what to expect whenever they purchase Amul. The trust lures them again and again. Amul also does that extra step and takes care of not just its consumers, but even suppliers. It provides assistance to millions of Indian farmers, follows fair trade practices, and is supportive of sustainable processes. It listens to customers and refigures its product based on constantly changing demands and wants.




Apart from that, Amul has also made its products widely available, even in rural and small towns. Its vast distribution network makes loyal customers find Amul products everywhere, with convenience and satisfaction. With such emphasis on availability, combined with affordability, the brand becomes a household name across all income segments. Through good communication, consistent quality, social responsibility, and customer care, Amul has established a bond of trust with customers. All such caring actions make individuals feel special, and this is the secret to long-term customer loyalty.

Tapan Kajagar
MBA - Finance

# Your Next Growth Hack Isn't a Campaign —It's a Community

In the modern times of the experience economy where transactions are the first touchpoint but the real magic happens when brands transform buyers into believers. Community building has emerged as the ultimate retention superpower that turns mere customers into enthusiastic contributors who voluntarily help to improve the product they like.

OnePlus hasn't just created a dent in the market; it has changed the rules by treating their community as co-founders. The "Never Settle" approach has transformed forum debates into product roadmaps where feedback from users has reflected in the optimisation of OxygenOS to the functionality of the alert slider. This crowdsourced R&D led to passionate loyalty among OnePlus fans that they formed an organic marketing army.

Samsung has enhanced this notion with its Samsung Members platform, a dynamic community in which millions troubleshoot, brainstorm and vote on future improvements. Implementing feedback from the users in One UI updates creates a strong psychological bond. It tells that the brand isn't just just selling to them but evolving with them.

Community focused brands achieve 30% higher retention (HBR) by reducing acquisition cost by 50% (Bain). From OnePlus's Lab-Testing programmes to Sephora's beauty enthusiasts swapping tips (and spending more), these aren't customer bases – they're innovation networks.

The future belongs to brands that believe their valuable R&D department is their community. The question isn't whether you can create one but rather afford not to. After all, in this age of connectivity, the organisations that flourish won't have customers but collaborators who will stay with the brand at every phase of business.

Krishna Gutte
MBA - HR

# UNLOCKING E-COMMERCE SUCCESS: STRATEGIES FOR IDENTIFYING HIGH-CONVERTING CUSTOMERS ON AMAZON AND FLIPKART

Identifying high-converting customers is crucial for e-commerce giants like Amazon and Flipkart. These platforms utilize advanced data analytics and customer behavior insights to target users who are more likely to make purchases, enhancing their marketing strategies and optimizing user experiences.

By analyzing customer interactions, purchase history, and preferences, both companies can tailor offerings, ensuring that they not only attract visitors but also foster long-term customer relationships, which are essential for sustained growth in the competitive e-commerce landscape. This involves recognizing the segments of the audience that are the most likely to make purchases and engage with the brand.

Flipkart employs behavioral segmentations to categorize customers into distinct groups such as browsers, lapsers, light users, heavy users, and super heavy users. These segmentations help in tailoring marketing efforts to each specific need and behavior. On the other hand, Amazon utilizes data analytics to track consumer interactions, purchase history, and preferences.

In the competitive landscape of e-commerce, identifying high-converting customers is essential for sustainable growth. By leveraging data analytics, targeted marketing strategies, and enhanced customer experiences.

**Garima Prasad**
**MBA -BFS**

# Conclusion

In today's hyper-competitive and tech-savvy world, customer retention isn't just a metric—it's a mindset. Brands like Tata Neu, Nykaa, Sephora, Zomato, Amazon, Flipkart, OnePlus, Samsung, and Amul are redefining loyalty by blending personalization, technology, community, and purpose. Whether it's Sephora's beauty-driven experiences, Zomato's smart meal matches, or Nykaa's win-back messages—each touchpoint is tailored, timely, and trust-building. Giants like Amazon and Flipkart decode customer behavior with data, while OnePlus and Samsung turn users into collaborators through thriving communities. Meanwhile, Amul proves that even traditional brands can stay ahead by being socially responsible, emotionally connected, and always accessible. At the heart of every strategy lies one powerful truth: when customers feel seen, heard, and valued, they don't just buy—they belong. From loyalty programs to human connections, these brands show that retention isn't about holding on tighter—it's about giving more reasons to stay. The future belongs to businesses that go beyond transactions and build relationships that last.

Yash Mutha
MBA -Finance

# COMMEMORATING BUSINESS IDEAS WITH BIZNOVATION

## BIZNOVATION : WHERE BUSINESS MEETS INNOVATION

The forum organised its paramount event Biznovation that provided entrepreneurs a vibrant platform to showcase their problem-solving abilities, business acumen, and innovative thinking. Biznovation was a feather in our glorious cap.The event had attracted 42 teams from various colleges across Pune, all competing to turn their entrepreneurial visions into reality. The event was structured in 2 rounds and attracted 42 teams in this inter-college event. The event was organised for 2 days on the 25th Feb and 27th Feb 2025. The event successfully reinforced its mission of nurturing innovation and equipping students with the knowledge and confidence to transform their ideas into impactful ventures. Students and their business ideas had received feedback from the panelists to develop viable business models, refine their strategies, and gain insights into real-world entrepreneurial challenges. The event acted as a catalyst to all the budding entrepreneurs.Students from various colleges such as Dr. D.Y. Patil , Amity University and Christ University congregated together and brainstormed their ideas into viable realities.Biznovation garnered reputed guests Mr. Santosh Sahane , Mr. Sumit Chuttar , Ms. Manjula Nair. Their experience in the field and knowledge gave a much needed boost to our students and their startup dreams. Biznovation acted as a stepping stone to all the students who have the zeal to enter into the entrepreneurial world.

**Sanjana Kashyap**
**MBA -HR**

# STRATEGIES FOR CUSTOMER RETENTION THROUGH MANJULA NAIR'S POINT OF VIEW

Mrs. Manjula Subhash Nair, Global CMO Partner & Seed Investor. As a Professional with extensive experience in investment and corporate strategy. Mrs. Nair has significantly contributed to the growth of multiple ventures worldwide. Her expertise in driving business development and strategic planning continues to inspire and shape the global business landscape.It is with great pleasure that through this newsletter we are getting insights from her regarding the strategies for customer retention

**Mrs. Manjula Subhash Nair, Global CMO Partner & Seed Investor**

"Customer retention goes beyond repeat business—it's about building lasting relationships. Understanding customers' growth challenges and standing by them during tough times builds trust and loyalty. True partnerships are not transactional; they are based on empathy and support. Vendors must listen actively, address pain points, and align with the customer's vision. Long-term retention thrives when we act as growth enablers, not just service providers. Cultural sensitivity also plays a key role—respecting regional nuances fosters deeper connections. Ultimately, retention is rooted in value creation, consistent engagement, and mutual respect, ensuring customers see us as partners, not just vendors."

**Vedashree Ghotkar**
**MBA - HR**

# SUCCESS STORIES

**1. Sweet Fish Media – B2B Podcasting Agency**

**Industry Services | Customer Gauge Client**
**Churn Reduction: 15% → 3% in under a year**

Facing high monthly churn, Sweet Fish Media launched a clear retention strategy with defined goals and timelines. They introduced quarterly podcast reviews, giving account managers the chance to consult clients on best practices and performance. This personalized engagement led to significant results—within 6 months, churn dropped by 10%, reaching just 3% in under a year.

**2. SugarCRM – Software Industry**

**Building customers for life through feedback and transparency**

SugarCRM prioritizes retention by embedding customer-centric thinking into every decision. They use VoC surveys, close feedback loops, and foster open communication through their community platform, SugarClub. A dedicated feedback ambassador team ensures timely action and cross-company alignment—strengthening trust and long-term relationships

### 3. HeidelbergCement - Manufacturing

HeidelbergCement developed a flexible customer experience program across 25 countries to address local needs and prevent churn. They appointed local experience champions to act on customer feedback and adjust strategies. A key focus is personalized follow-up calls to detractors and passives, which has driven a 70% survey response rate and stronger customer relationships.

# RIDDLES

1. I am crucial for a business to stay alive, as important as gaining new patrons; what am I?

2. I am India's most trusted dairy brand, known for connecting and going the extra mile; what brand am I?

3. I ensure that customers know what to expect every time they purchase; what am I known for?

4. I assist millions of Indian farmers and follow fair trade practices; what am I a supporter of?

5. I can elevate your customer experience, whether you're running a food venture or a fashion start-up; what am I?

6. I introduced quarterly podcast reviews, significantly reducing client churn; what am I?

7. I prioritize retention by embedding customer centric thinking into every decision; what company am I?

8. I developed a flexible customer experience program across 25 countries; what am I?

9. I have emerged as the ultimate retention superpower, turning customers into enthusiastic contributors; what am I?

10. My "Never Settle" approach has transformed forum debates into product road maps; what company am I?

**ANSWERS**

1. Retaining current customers
2. Amul
3. Quality Consistency
4. Sustainable Processes
5. Zomato's personalization
6. Personalization
7. Sweet Fish Media's retention strategy
8. Sugar CRM
9. HeidelbergCement's customer experience program
10. Community Building
11. OnePlus

**Varad Mulgund**
**MBA - BA**

# WHAT'S HAPPENING IN THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD?

Entrepreneurship is evolving rapidly, fueled by bold ideas, innovative ventures, and disruptive technologies that are reshaping the business landscape. This edition highlights key developments and insights vital for entrepreneurs, startups, and business leaders to stay ahead in an ever-changing world.

**1. India Hosts BRICS Youth Council Entrepreneurship Meeting:**

**Date: March 3–7, 2025**
India's Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports organized a BRICS Youth Council meeting in New Delhi, themed "Youth Entrepreneurship for Sustainable Growth." Around 45 youth representatives from BRICS nations gathered to discuss collaborative policies supporting entrepreneurship.

**2. L&T Semiconductor Technologies Plans $10 Billion Fab in India**

**Date: March 5, 2025**
L&T Semiconductor Technologies announced a $10 billion semiconductor fabrication plant, targeting completion by 2027. The initiative aims to strengthen India's chip manufacturing sector, contingent on reaching $1 billion in annual revenue by FY 2026–27.

**3. Techstars Update: Neural Defend Raises Pre-Seed Round**

**Date: March 10, 2025**
Neural Defend, an AI-driven cybersecurity startup from Techstars' 2025 cohort, secured over $600,000 in pre-seed funding to advance its AI-based security solutions.

**4. Startup Mahakumbh 2025 Announced**

**Date: March 20, 2025**
Billed as the world's largest innovation showcase, Startup Mahakumbh 2025 will take place from April 3–5 in New Delhi, featuring 3,000+ startups and 1,000+ investors from 50+ countries.

**5. Sandbox AQ Secures $150 Million**

**Date: March 2025**
Sandbox AQ raised $150M, bringing its Series E total to $450M and valuation to $5.75B. Backed by Google and Nvidia, it develops AI and quantum tools, with solutions offered via Google Cloud.

Saanya Nair
MBA - Finance E

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